

» FIGHT CLUB

BEHOLD THE CHALLENGER

Merab Dvalishvili's long pursuit of a title shot **culminates in a showdown** against Sean O'Malley for the bantamweight championship at UFC 306 in Las Vegas.

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AFP



Merab Dvalishvili's long-standing wish will be finally fulfilled in a few weeks.

'The Machine' is set to take on reigning bantamweight champion Sean O'Malley (**left; standing**) for the belt at UFC 306 at the Sphere in Las Vegas on September 14. UFC CEO Dana White announced this fight via an *Instagram* live session last week.

"This is good; he has finally mentioned my name, and now we are going to fight. Because I have been calling him for six years, and he has been ignoring me. It feels good that he finally wants to fight me," said Dvalishvili in an interview.

The O'Malley vs. Dvalishvili bout has been in the works since March. In February, Dvalishvili defeated Henry Cejudo by unanimous decision at UFC 298 before O'Malley beat Marlon Vera at UFC 299 in March.

O'Malley, known for his electrifying fighting style, will seek his second title defence after notable victories over Aljamain Sterling and Marlon 'Chito' Vera. O'Malley has maintained a six-fight winning streak, excluding a no-contest against Pedro Munhoz.

His challenger, Dvalishvili, boasts a remarkable 10-fight win streak and